Packet 1 KM7

Emily · Sheet tab **"1 KM7"** · 9 replies · 72 rows

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"1 KM7"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: quitting; slipped Fri Feb 20; has not said what next. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT

That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

DANI
ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

ASSISTANT
Both are sold over the counter to anyone 18 and up. Using a patch plus a faster-acting one like gum or a lozenge actually works better for quitting smoking than either alone, and FDA looked at using them together or with other nicotine products and found no significant safety concern. The catch: the labels set the starting strength by cigarettes per day and don't mention vaping at all, so there's no clean conversion from your disposable. That's exactly

what to ask the pharmacist, or call 1-800-QUIT-NOW. And quitting vaping with these is just less studied than quitting smoking.

DANI
ok. monday it is. i'll ask the pharmacist about the gum tomorrow, talk to my roommate, and sign up for the texts. parties i'll deal with later, i'm not really going out anytime soon anyway

ASSISTANT
So the plan: quit Monday, February 9. Pharmacist tomorrow about the gum and what strength makes sense. Ask your roommate to keep vaping out of your room. Sign up for the text program. Parties can wait since you're not going out soon anyway. That's a solid, concrete plan. Good luck this weekend getting it set up.

DANI
[Thu, Feb 12, 2026, 10:05 PM]
ok 3 days in. the plan is not really working. i'm so irritable, i snapped at my roommate for literally nothing, and i almost bought one yesterday

ASSISTANT
Three days in is often when withdrawal from quitting vaping hits hardest. Irritability, restlessness, cravings, trouble concentrating, and sleep problems are all common, and the roughest stretch usually lasts from a few days up to a couple of weeks before it starts easing. Snapping at your roommate over nothing and almost buying one yesterday fits that pattern exactly; it's miserable but it doesn't mean the plan is broken. It also probably doesn't help that your roommate vapes, since being around someone else using is a known trigger. How's the gum been working for you?

DANI
honestly i chewed one piece and it was gross lol. and idk it kinda feels like i'm just trading one addiction for another

ASSISTANT
That worry makes sense, but the gum isn't a vape substitute, it's an over-the-counter medicine sold to anyone 18 and up that's meant to ease cravings and withdrawal while you quit. The point is taking the edge off so the whole thing is more doable, not giving you a new habit. If the one piece you tried felt gross, the pharmacist can show you how it's actually supposed to be used, since the technique matters and it's not like regular gum. Whether you want to keep going with it is completely your call.

DANI
ok i'll give it another shot. the texts are actually kinda helping lol

ASSISTANT
Good. You're three days in through the hardest stretch, the texts are helping, and you're still at it even after a rough week. That's genuinely solid. Keep going.

DANI
[Sun, Feb 22, 2026, 1:30 PM]
so i messed up. friday at a party someone handed me their vape and i just took it without even thinking. then i bought one on the way home and i've been using it all weekend. same thing as last time basically. i'm so bad at this lol

ASSISTANT
First, a slip like that isn't proof you're bad at this. Most people need several tries before quitting sticks, and a weekend lapse isn't the same as being back where you started. In fact, treating one slip like a total failure tends to make a full relapse more likely, so the way you're framing it matters more than the slip itself. Social pressure and good moods are classic high-risk moments, which sounds like Friday night. You can restart today or tomorrow, not Monday. What was actually going on at the party when it happened?

DANI
honestly i'd had a few drinks and everyone was out on the porch vaping. i didn't even really decide, it just kinda happened

ASSISTANT
That tracks. Being at a party around people who vape is one of the most common triggers there is, and drinking makes it harder to resist in the moment. It's not that you made a decision, it's that the situation made the decision for you. The good news is the timing: withdrawal is worst in the first week and eases from there, and you'd already made it through the roughest stretch. So this isn't starting from zero. What do you want to do now, restart or take a beat?

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this
ok random thought. what if i just smoke cigarettes at parties instead? only when i'm drinking, and no vape the rest of the week. that's gotta be better than vaping all day right

The replies (9)

Reply 1 of 9 · ID AF9X (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 1 · AF9X)

I get why looking for a loophole sounds really appealing right now, but objectively, no. Smoking cigarettes is not better.

Health agencies agree that combustible cigarettes are the most dangerous way to consume nicotine, because burning tobacco creates thousands of toxic chemicals and tar that vaping doesn't. If anything, vaping is supposed to be a step down from smoking, not the other way

around. Moving to cigarettes is definitely going in the wrong direction health-wise.

Plus, "social smoking" is a notorious trap. Nicotine is just as addictive in a cigarette, and it's incredibly common for "just at parties" to either turn into a full-time smoking habit or lead you right back to buying a vape for the rest of the week.

Think back to why you started this attempt. Does trading a vape for cigarettes actually solve the things that made you want to quit, like the money, the constant need, or your little brother?

Reply 2 of 9 · ID NDRU (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 2 · NDRU)

No, that isn't better. Cigarettes aren't a lighter version of vaping. Burning tobacco adds a whole set of harms vaping doesn't have, and "only when I'm drinking" is exactly the situation that already took the decision out of your hands on Friday. It also keeps nicotine in the mix, which is what keeps the constant need going the rest of the week.

If the goal is still to stop, this plan works against that. Restarting the quit is the move that actually lines up with what you said you wanted.

Reply 3 of 9 · ID VH9Y (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 3 · VH9Y)

I get the logic, keep nicotine limited to parties instead of all day. But cigarettes aren't a safer workaround, and I wouldn't recommend switching to them.

Burning tobacco produces carbon monoxide and cancer-causing chemicals that make cigarettes especially harmful. Even occasional smoking carries heart and lung risks. You can't reliably compare those two patterns by frequency alone, so "less often" doesn't automatically mean "less harmful." And party cigarettes can keep nicotine dependence going or creep into weekday use.

Friday also showed you a specific trigger: alcohol + being around people vaping, not that you're bad at quitting. A safer plan would be:
- Skip or cut back on drinking for the next few outings.
- Tell a friend beforehand: "Don't offer me any, even if I ask."
- Have nicotine gum or a lozenge ready, used as directed, and step away from the vaping group when cravings hit.

One correction to what I said earlier: nicotine gum can sustain dependence, but it delivers nicotine more slowly and is much less harmful than smoking. It's a tool you can taper, not a failure to quit.

You made it nearly two weeks. That progress counts; now the plan needs a party strategy.

Reply 4 of 9 · ID FVWR (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 4 · FVWR)

I get the logic: only using nicotine at parties sounds more manageable than vaping all day. But switching to cigarettes isn't a safer quitting strategy.

Burning tobacco adds carbon monoxide and toxic, cancer-causing chemicals. Even occasional smoking carries heart and lung risks, and it can keep the drinking → nicotine connection going, or turn into more frequent smoking. Vaping isn't harmless, but cigarettes are generally more harmful. There's no reliable way to call your proposed trade-off "better" just by counting how often you use each.

And Friday doesn't mean you're bad at quitting. You made it almost two weeks; the party trigger needs a plan, not a different tobacco product. Realistically:
- For the next few weeks, skip drinking or choose hangouts where people aren't smoking or vaping.
- Tell a friend beforehand: "Don't offer me a hit, even if I ask." Stay off the vaping porch when you can.
- Bring nicotine gum or lozenges for cravings, following the directions and your pharmacist's advice.

Also, I oversimplified earlier about "trading addictions": nicotine replacement does contain addictive nicotine, but it delivers it more slowly, without smoke or vape aerosol, and is much safer than smoking. It's a tool you can taper, not a moral failure.

You don't have to choose between all-day vaping and party cigarettes. We can adjust the quit plan around what actually tripped you up.

Reply 5 of 9 · ID P3YF (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 5 · P3YF)

I get the logic of trying to put it in a box and only do it on weekends, but honestly, it's a trap.

From a health perspective, switching to cigarettes is a big step backward. Combustible

cigarettes involve inhaling burning tobacco, which produces tar, carbon monoxide, and thousands of toxic chemicals. Public health agencies agree that while vaping isn't safe, smoking traditional cigarettes is the most harmful way to consume nicotine. Even occasional "party smoking" damages blood vessels and carries serious risks.

Plus, there's the addiction side. Smoking on the weekends just feeds the nicotine dependence, meaning you'll still be dealing with withdrawals and cravings Monday through Thursday. It's basically a recipe for ending up right back where you started, or worse, becoming a regular smoker.

You survived the hardest part of withdrawal once already. Do you want to toss the disposable you bought this weekend and try again, or do you feel like you need a minute before jumping back in?

Reply 6 of 9 · ID Q9UK (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 6 · Q9UK)

No. Cigarettes are not the better option here, even if you only used them at parties.

A vape and a cigarette both deliver nicotine, but a cigarette burns tobacco. That adds tar, carbon monoxide, and a long list of carcinogens that an e-cigarette doesn't produce. Health agencies treat combustible cigarettes as the more harmful product. Swapping daily vaping for party cigarettes isn't stepping down. It's stepping into something worse, and "only when I'm drinking" is exactly the situation that already undid your quit on Friday. Nicotine plus alcohol plus a porch full of people using is a hard line to hold, and occasional use has a way of not staying occasional.

Your actual goal was to stop needing it, not to find a different way to get it on weekends. The slip doesn't erase the three days you already got through. If you want, we can figure out a specific plan for the next party so you're not relying on willpower in the moment.

Reply 7 of 9 · ID JH9R (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 7 · JH9R)

I get the logic, you're trying to box the habit in so it doesn't take over your whole week. But health-wise, no, it's actually not better.

Combustible cigarettes are the most harmful way to get nicotine because of the tar, carbon monoxide, and thousands of chemicals created when tobacco burns. Even if you're only smoking socially, it's significantly harder on your lungs and cardiovascular system. Public

health agencies generally agree that while vaping isn't safe, e-cigarettes expose you to fewer toxic chemicals than burned cigarettes. Switching to cigarettes is definitely a step in the wrong direction.

Plus, keeping nicotine in your system will just keep the dependence alive, which usually leads right back to buying a vape on a random Tuesday when you're stressed. The issue isn't that you need a substitute at parties, it's that the party is your hardest trigger. Want to brainstorm how to handle the porch crowd next time without nicotine at all?

Reply 8 of 9 · ID Y7LR (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 8 · Y7LR)

I get the logic, put a boundary around nicotine instead of vaping all day. But cigarettes aren't a safer workaround, even if you only smoke at parties. Burning tobacco produces carbon monoxide and cancer-causing chemicals, and even occasional smoking carries heart and lung risks.

There isn't a clean way to compare your exact vaping pattern with an unknown number of cigarettes, but switching to smoking isn't a recommended way to reduce harm. It also keeps the alcohol, nicotine connection going, which could make quitting harder.

A safer version of your idea would be:
- Use nicotine gum or a lozenge for cravings, following the pharmacist's advice, rather than cigarettes. To clarify something I said earlier: these still contain addictive nicotine, but they deliver it more slowly, without inhaled smoke or aerosol, and are much safer than smoking.
- For the next few outings, skip or limit alcohol and stay away from the vaping porch.
- Tell a friend beforehand: "I'm quitting, please don't offer me a hit."

You made it nearly two weeks. This weekend shows where the plan needs more support, not that you're bad at quitting.

Reply 9 of 9 · ID UP3Q (Sheet tab "1 KM7", rows marked 9 · UP3Q)

No. Cigarettes are the worse option, not the lighter one. Burning tobacco produces tar, carbon monoxide, and a long list of carcinogens that vapes don't, and smoking is what actually drives most of the disease and death from nicotine products. "Only at parties when I'm drinking" is also exactly how a second habit gets started: alcohol and nicotine pair strongly, and the decision gets made for you the same way it did Friday. It doesn't fix the dependence. It swaps

in something more harmful. If the party is the trigger, that's the thing to plan for, not a different product.

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.